Paper Squeezing Machine

Category: **Sewing, Textile & Handicraft** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Paper Squeezing Machine (Water removal from pulp)

What it is used for

A paper squeezing machine removes excess water from wet paper pulp or formed paper sheets by applying pressure. It helps prepare the material for drying and further paper-making processes.

Main parts

- Identify the pressing rollers or compression plates that squeeze the wet pulp.
- Locate the feed area where wet pulp or sheets are placed.
- Identify the discharge area for pressed pulp or sheets.
- Locate the motor, drive mechanism and transmission components, where fitted.
- Identify the pressure adjustment and operating controls.
- Locate protective guards and the emergency stop mechanism.
- Identify the water collection tray, drainage channel and supporting frame.

Before you start

1. Read the operating instructions and obtain teacher supervision before use.
2. Inspect rollers, plates, guards, electrical cables and drainage channels for damage.
3. Ensure the machine is stable and correctly assembled.
4. Check that the water collection tray and drainage outlets are clear.
5. Prepare wet pulp or sheets according to the machine's capacity.
6. Tie back long hair and remove jewellery and loose clothing.
7. Keep the working area dry and clear of unnecessary materials.

How to use

1. Switch off and isolate power before making adjustments or preparing the feed area.
2. Check that the pressure setting suits the material and machine instructions.
3. Position the wet pulp or sheet evenly in the designated feed area.
4. Ensure the material does not extend into unsafe areas around the rollers.
5. Close guards and confirm that the emergency stop is accessible.
6. Start the machine using the designated control.
7. Feed the material gradually using the approved feeding arrangement.
8. Monitor water drainage and the uniformity of the pressing operation.
9. Stop feeding if material bunches, slips or causes abnormal noise.
10. Switch off and wait for all moving parts to stop before removing material.
11. Collect the pressed material and transfer it for further drying.

⚠ Safety

- Never place fingers or hands between rollers or pressing plates.
- Do not wear loose gloves near rotating rollers or exposed moving parts.
- Keep protective guards in place throughout operation.
- Isolate power before clearing jams, cleaning or adjusting the machine.
- Keep water away from electrical controls and damaged connections.
- Report unusual vibration, noise or pressure changes immediately.

Care & storage

- Disconnect power before removing pulp residue and accumulated debris.
- Clean rollers, plates and drainage channels using approved methods.
- Inspect guards, fasteners and drive components regularly for damage.
- Store the machine clean and dry after completing maintenance.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Feeding uneven or oversized pulp batches that cause jamming.
- Applying excessive pressure that damages sheets or machine components.
- Reaching between rollers to reposition material while the machine runs.
- Allowing drained water and pulp residue to accumulate around the machine.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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